

Program Proposal: Rise Above Pressure Youth Initiative

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Program Overview

The *Rise Above Pressure Program* is a prevention and support program designed to address the growing issues of:

- Vaping and substance exposure in schools
- Peer pressure and risky behaviors
- Early decision-making around relationships and self-image

This program combines **real-life testimonies**, **interactive education**, and **family support resources**, emotional resilience to empower students to make positive, informed decisions.

At RAPP, we believe prevention is more than saying “NO.” It’s about giving young people the emotional resilience, mentorship, confidence, and support system needed to rise above, drugs, gangs, and negative peer pressure for a stronger future.

Program Goals

- Reduce student involvement in vaping and substance use
 - Equip students with tools to resist peer pressure to rise above pressure
 - Strengthen self-confidence and decision-making
 - Support parents in identifying and addressing risk behaviors
 - Provide mentorship pathways for at-risk youth
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Key Topics

Vaping & Selling in schools

- Show how easy access happens
- Explain consequences (school + legal)
- Show how addiction forms

Peer Pressure (“Big Dawgs” mentality)

- Role -play scenarios
- Teach responses teens can actually use

Sexual Pressure / Early Behavior

- Self - worth
- Long - term thinking
- Emotional consequences
- Respect for themselves

People to Include

- Former inmates (transformed lives)
- Recovering addicts
- Young adults students can relate to
- Counselor or youth mentors
- cops , sheriffs, detectives etc

Program Components

♦ **1. Student Assembly (30-40 minutes)**

- Real-life speakers (formerly incarcerated, recovered individuals, youth mentors)
- Honest discussion about consequences and turning points
- Encouraging message focused on hope and change

♦ **2. Parent Support Session**

- Signs of vaping and risky behaviors
- Communication strategies with teens
- Access to local support resources

Why This Program Works

- Students relate to **real stories, not lectures**
- Focuses on **prevention + support**, not punishment
- Includes **parents**, creating stronger impact
- Promotes **positive identity and future goals**

Program Concept (Modern D.A.R.E.-Style, But Real)

Core Idea

A student + parent support program that combines:

- Real-life testimonies (people who lived it)
- Education on vaping, drugs, gangs, peer pressure
- Life skills (confidence, decision-making, identity)
- Family support (parent included, not left out)

Truth + Tools + Transformation

What Makes This Program Different

- **Real people with real stories**
- Reasons why teens fall into it
- Create alert on how teens behavior, upset, isolation, phone usage
- Ongoing support (not just a one-time talk)
- Become leaders not followers
- Emotional Resilience
- Tools to say NO with confidence
- Support for students and parents
- A safe place to talk without judgment

RISE ABOVE

Real Stories. Real Choices. Real Change.

Are today's pressures too much for our youth?

- 🚫 Vaping
- 🚫 Peer pressure
- 🚫 Risky decisions

👉 It's time for something different.

For Students

You are not alone.

Your future is bigger than one decision.

For Parents

Learn how to:

- Signs your child is vaping/ warning signs
- How kids hide it
- How to talk without pushing them away
- Talk to your child effectively
- What to do if they're already involved
- Get support when needed

Example Opening RAPP Sessions

"How many of you have seen someone vape at school?
Be honest... how many of you have been offered it?"

(Pause, let them react)

"I'm not here to judge you. I'm here because I was you... just a few years ahead—and I wish someone had told me the truth."

◆ Part 1: "How It Started" (Relatable)

"It didn't start with something big.
It started with fitting in...
Wanting to be part of the group...
Not wanting to feel left out."

👉 Mention:

- Friends / wanting to belong
 - Pressure
 - Curiosity
 - Social media influence
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◆ Part 2: "The Trap"

"Nobody wakes up and says 'I want to mess up my life.'
It happens little by little."

Examples:

- Vaping → addiction
- Selling at school or outside school → quick money → trouble
- Hanging with the wrong crowd.
- Legal consequences

“What felt small... started getting bigger.”

♦ **Part 3: “The Consequences” (Real but not graphic)**

“I lost trust... opportunities... and almost my future.”

👉 Keep it real:

- Legal trouble
 - School consequences
 - Family impact
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♦ **Part 4: “The Turning Point”**

“There was a moment I had to decide—
keep going... or change everything.”

👉 “I found something bigger than myself... and I started rebuilding.”

♦ **Identity & Confidence**

- Saying **NO** without losing friends
- Choosing better circles
- Self-respect
- Resiliense

♦ **Future Vision**

- Goals vs. distractions
 - Real examples of success after struggle
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“REAL LIFE SCENARIOS”

Ask students:

👉 “What would you do if...”

- Your friend offers you a vape?
- Someone says “everyone is doing it”?
- You feel left out?

Then give them **actual responses**:

- “I’m good, I got other plans”
- “Not worth it”
- Walk away strategy

♦ **Part 5: “Message to Students”**

“You don’t have to go through what I went through to learn the lesson.”

“Being strong isn’t doing what everyone else is doing—
it’s walking away when you know it’s wrong.”

♦ **Closing Line (Memorable)**

*“Your future is bigger than this moment.
Don’t trade it for something temporary.”*